577 – Employee Bonus

PLATFORM Platform: LeetCode

DIFFICULTY EASY

DATE Solved: June 5, 2026

Problem

Find the **name** and **bonus** of employees whose:

- Bonus is **less than 1000**, OR
- They **do not have a bonus record**.

Execution Flow

- Read all employees.
- Join with bonus information using `LEFT JOIN`.
- Keep rows where:bonus < 1000, or
- bonus is NULL.
- Return employee name and bonus.

Concepts Used

1. LEFT JOIN

```
LEFT JOIN Bonus b
ON e.empId = b.empId
```

A `LEFT JOIN` returns:

- All rows from the `Employee` table.
- Matching rows from the `Bonus` table.
- `NULL` if no matching bonus exists.

2. Filter Low Bonuses

`b.bonus < 1000`

Selects employees whose bonus is less than 1000.

3. Include Employees Without Bonus

`b.bonus IS NULL`

Selects employees who don't have a record in the `Bonus` table.

4. OR Operator

```
WHERE b.bonus < 1000
   OR b.bonus IS NULL
```

An employee is returned if **either** condition is true.